OUR STORY

IIDEBATE : THE JOURNEY

The International Institute of Debate

Small Intro

THE INTERNATIONAL INSTITUTE OF DEBATE COMMONLY KNOWN AS IIDEBATE IS AN INTERNATIONAL ORGANIZATION OF YOUTH LEADERS FROM FIVE ARAB COUNTRIES BASED IN TUNISIA. IIDEBATE IS A NON-PARTISAN NON-PROFIT, THAT WORKS ON DEVELOPING THE NEXT GENERATION OF CIVIC LEADERS, ACTIVISTS AND POLICYMAKERS BY GIVING YOUNG PEOPLE THE OPPORTUNITY TO ACTIVELY PARTICIPATE IN THE DECISION-MAKING PROCESS.

THE INTERNATIONAL INSTITUTE OF DEBATE WORKS ON THE FOLLOWING **THREE GOALS :**

EDUCATIONAL JUSTICE : THIS WILL BE ACHIEVED BY REFORMING THE CLASSIC WAYS OF EDUCATION THROUGH THE INTEGRATION OF DEBATE TECHNIQUES AND NON-FORMAL EDUCATION WITHIN THE DAILY LIFE OF THE EDUCATIONAL INSTITUTIONS.

REHABILITATION & SOCIAL JUSTICE : THIS WILL BE ACHIEVED BY EMPOWERING VULNERABLE YOUTH THAT NEED SPECIAL SUPPORT TO BECOME AN INTEGRATED PART OF SOCIETY BY HELPING THEM LEAD A NORMAL LIFE OUT OF THE DISCRIMINATION AND EXCLUSION.

COMMUNITY RESILIENCE : THIS WILL BE ACHIEVED BY TARGETING COMMUNITIES WITH LOW YOUTH PARTICIPATION RATES ACCOMPANIED BY ACUTE SOCIAL PROBLEMS. THROUGH TRANSFORMING THE PASSIVENESS INTO ACTION, LOCAL ENTITIES WILL BE EMPOWERED TO CONDUCT A NEEDS ASSESSMENT AND RESOURCE ANALYSIS. CONSEQUENTLY, THEY WILL ENGAGE LOCAL & REGIONAL AUTHORITIES TO COLLABORATE ON THE NEEDED ACTIONS FOR THE COMMUNITY.

Letter from our Director

DEAR IIDEBATE FAMILY,

WE HAVE BEEN ON THIS JOURNEY FOR MORE THAN 6 YEARS. IT HASN'T BEEN AN EASY RIDE BUT I HAVE TO SAY THAT I AM PROUD OF EVERY MOMENT OF STRUGGLE AND GRATEFUL FOR EVERY CHALLENGE ENCOUNTERED.

WHEN THE INTERNATIONAL INTERNATIONAL INSTITUTE OF DEBATE WAS JUST AN IDEA, WE WERE A GROUP OF YOUNG UNIVERSITY STUDENTS WITH A DIFFERENT VISION OF WHAT THE EDUCATION SYSTEM SHOULD BE LIKE. EVEN THOUGH TUNISIA CAN BE PROUD OF ITS ACHIEVEMENTS IN TERMS OF EDUCATION, THE COUNTRY IS STILL LAGGING BEHIND IN TERMS OF QUALITY EDUCATION FOR ALL. THERE WERE CLEAR DISPARITIES THAT NEEDED TO BE TACKLED. IIDEBATE'S VISION TO ACHIEVE FOCUSED ON YOUTH ACTIVISM AS THE KEY TO SOLVING THE PROBLEMS AT HAND.

AFTER THE REVOLUTION, THERE WAS A CLEAR ROOM FOR CIVIL SOCIETY ACTIVISM AND THE CO-FOUNDERS OF IIDEBATE WERE AWARE OF THAT. THUS, AN INITIATIVE STARTED BY A GROUP OF THREE PEOPLE WHO BELIEVED IN THE POSSIBILITY OF CHANGE. AT FIRST OUR ORGANIZATION FELT LIKE AN ANT TRYING TO BATTLE WITH AN ELEPHANT. THE SYSTEM WAS STILL RIGID AFTER DECADES OF DICTATORSHIP AND NOT EVERYTHING COULD BE BENT EASILY. HOWEVER, WE WERE DETERMINED TO CARRY IT THROUGH TILL THE END.

WITH A VISION TO ENGAGE EVERY YOUNG PERSON TO BECOME AN ACTIVE CITIZEN WITHIN THEIR COMMUNITY, IIDEBATE HAS BEEN HARD AT WORK TRYING TO MAKE ITS IMPACT DECENTRALIZED. OUR ACTIVITIES FOCUSED MAINLY ON DELIVERING TRAINING, ORGANIZING COMPETITIONS AND CONFERENCES ALONGSIDE SUPPORTING YOUTH INITIATIVES THE WORK OF IIDEBATE STANDS OUT WITHIN THE TUNISIAN CIVIL SOCIETY FOR ITS DECENTRALIZED APPROACH.

KEEPING IN MIND THE DEVELOPMENT GAP BETWEEN THAT RURAL AND URBAN AREAS IN TUNISIA, EVERY PROJECT ORGANIZED BY OUR ORGANIZATION TOUCHES ALL SORTS OF REGIONS AROUND THE COUNTRY TO ENSURE THAT THE IMPACT IS ON A NATIONAL LEVEL. THERE IS AN ENORMOUS UNEXPLOITED POTENTIAL IN OUR YOUTH THAT MUST BE VALORIZED.

OUR BELIEF IN YOUTH AND THE IMPORTANCE OF EDUCATION STEMS FROM THE IMPACT OF THE LATTER. ONCE EDUCATIONAL JUSTICE IS ACHIEVED, NUMEROUS SOCIAL AND ECONOMIC ISSUES WILL DIMINISH. THE TRADITIONAL FORMAT OF EDUCATION IS NOT ENOUGH TO EMPOWER STUDENTS AND GIVE THEM THE CONFIDENCE THEY NEED. WE HAVE IDENTIFIED THAT NON-FORMAL EDUCATION PLAYS A CRUCIAL ROLE IN HELPING YOUTH DEVELOP THEIR OWN PERSONAL SUCCESS FORMULA. AT THE SAME TIME, TO ENSURE A HOLISTIC APPROACH TO OUR WORK, SOCIAL JUSTICE HAD TO BE INTEGRATED KNOWING THAT CERTAIN GROUPS WITHIN SOCIETY HAVE SOCIAL OBSTACLES PREVENTING THEM FROM DEVELOPING THEMSELVES. THROUGH THESE TWO GOALS, IIDEBATE WILL CONTRIBUTE TO MAKING COMMUNITIES AROUND TUNISIA MORE RESILIENT WITH ITS RESPECTIVE YOUTH PRIMARILY. EACH BENEFICIARY WE DEAL WITH HAS A DIFFERENT STORY AND A UNIQUE MOTIVATION THAT INSPIRES THE ENTIRE TEAM TO KEEP GOING.

A PROFOUND THANK YOU TO ALL THOSE WHO MAKE OUR WORK POSSIBLE; OUR DEDICATED STAFF, FACILITATORS, TRAINERS, VOLUNTEERS, PARTNERS AND DONORS. A SPECIAL SHOUT OUT TO DRABZEEN HUMAN DEVELOPMENT AND THEIR ENTIRE TEAM FOR HELPING US SPREAD OUR MESSAGE AND WORK THROUGHOUT THE ENTIRE MENA REGION.

SINCERELY,

Elyes Guermazi
FOUNDER & DIRECTOR

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ESSENTIAL *Facts*

WHAT
NON-GOVERNMENTAL ORGANIZATION
REGISTERED IN TUNISIA & JORDAN

WHEN
ESTABLISHED IN 2013

WHERE
TUNIS, TUNISIA
&
AMMAN, JORDAN

WHO
YOUTH

HOW
DELIVERING TRAINING
ORGANIZING CONFERENCES AND COMPETITIONS
CREATING PROJECTS.

VALUES
DEMOCRACY
SOLIDARITY
DIALOGUE
ENGAGEMENT
TRANSPARENCY

Our MISSION

TO

DEVELOP THE NEXT GENERATION OF CIVIC LEADERS, ACTIVISTS, AND CHANGE AGENTS BY ALLOWING YOUTH TO PARTICIPATE IN THE POLITICAL PROCESS ACTIVELY.

Our VISION

ENGAGE EVERY YOUNG PERSON TO BECOME AN ACTIVE CITIZEN IN THEIR COMMUNITY.

Achievements

2013

20
PROJECTS

+150
PARTNERSHIPS

24
REGIONS

14
CHAPTERS

+10K
PARTICIPANTS
INCLUDING +3K TEENAGERS

6
INNOVATION AND RESEARCH CENTERS

+250
TRAINING SESSIONS

"

A CHALLENGE CAN'T BE OVERCOME WITHOUT A COMPREHENSIVE INTENSE DISCUSSION THAT INVOLVE ALL POTENTIAL STAKEHOLDERS; A LESSON, I PERSONALLY LEARNT THROUGHOUT MY EXPERIENCE WITH IIDEBATE IN TERMS OF COMMUNICATION, MANAGEMENT AND RISK ASSESSMENT

Nizar Ben Salah

"

OUMAIMA ZAYEN
20 YEARS
STUDENT
SFAX

"

BE THE CHANGE YOU WISH TO SEE IN THE WORLD

Oumaima Zayen

"

"

WHEN YOU INTEGRATE CIVIL SOCIETY, YOU GO FROM SOUND WHO JUST SITS AROUND COMPLAINING AND CRITICIZING IN COFFEE SHOPS TO SOMEONE WHO CAN FIX THINGS AND MAKE CHANGE HAPPEN

Aziz Ben Fraj

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"

A CHALLENGE CAN'T BE OVERCOME WITHOUT A COMPREHENSIVE INTENSE DISCUSSION THAT INVOLVE ALL POTENTIAL STAKEHOLDERS; A LESSON, I PERSONALLY LEARNT THROUGHOUT MY EXPERIENCE WITH IIDEBATE IN TERMS OF COMMUNICATION, MANAGEMENT AND RISK ASSESSMENT

Youssef Habboul

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Our Programs

KHALINI NEKHTAR

IIDEBATE'S FIRST MAJOR EVENT AIMED AT TACKLING THE CONFUSION OF DECISION MAKING FOR TUNISIAN HIGH SCHOOL STUDENTS. IN PARTNERSHIP WITH THE BRITICH COUNCIL, KHALINI NEKHTAR WAS ORGANIZED TO ENGAGE 1,000 PARTICIPANTS INCLUDING STUDENTS, PROFESSIONALS AND PARENTS FROM TEN REGIONS AROUND THE COUNTRY IN AN EDUCATION FAIR.

THE EVENT ALLOWED PARTICIPANTS TO COLLECT INFORMATION AND EXPLORE POTENTIAL CAREER PATHS WHILE MEETING WITH DIFFERENT UNIVERSITIES AND PROFESSIONALS WHILE GETTING THEIR ORIENTATION RELATED QUESTIONS ANSWERED.

DRABZEEN ACADEMY

Drabzeen
ACADEMY TUNISIA

THE ACADEMY OFFERS ACTIVE YOUTH FROM VARIOUS REGIONS A 15 MONTHS TRAINING CYCLE TO LEAD THEM FROM FACILITATORS TO TRAINERS AND FINALLY MASTER TRAINERS. THE PARTICIPANTS SPECIALIZE IN DEBATE, COMMUNICATION AND CAPACITY BUILDING FOR NGOS. THEIR WORK IS DECENTRALIZED TO CREATE IMPACT ON AS MANY REGIONS AS POSSIBLE. THE DRABZEEN ACADEMY INCLUDES A CENTRALIZED PART THAT FOCUSES ON PROVIDING TRAINING SESSIONS TO PROFESSIONALS AND BUSINESSES. WORKING ON 16 REGIONS, DRABZEEN ACADEMY COUNTS 9 TRAINERS AND 14 FACILITATORS.

Our Programs

TOUNSI W NGHAYER

TO ENCOURAGE YOUTH TO BE CREATE IMMEDIATE IMPACT WITHIN THEIR LOCAL COMMUNITIES, TOUNSI W NGHAYER WAS DEVISED ON TWO OCCASIONS REACHING OUT TO 11 REGIONS AROUND TUNISIA. THROUGH TRAINING YOUNG STUDENTS IN CIVIC ENGAGEMENT, ADVOCACY, PUBLIC SPEAKING AND JOURNALISM, THE PROJECT DISSEMINATED THE ACQUIRED SKILLS WITHIN THE REGIONS OF WORK. THE BENEFICIARIES WORKED ON SERVING THE NEEDS OF THEIR LOCAL COMMUNITY THROUGH MINI PROJECTS THAT ATTEMPT TO RESHAPE THE EDUCATION SYSTEM IN TUNISIA. MEANWHILE, THE PARTICIPANTS WORKED ON RAISING AWARENESS TO OTHER YOUTH WITHIN THEIR COMMUNITY ABOUT THE IMPORTANCE OF CIVIC EDUCATION.

CAFE TALK

TO CAPITALIZE ON THE TIME SPENT BY YOUTH IN CAFÉS, "CAFÉ TALKS" WERE ORGANIZED AS AN OPEN DISCUSSION BETWEEN YOUTH ABOUT VARIOUS LOCAL AND GLOBAL ISSUES. IT'S COMMON TO FIND YOUTH EXPRESSING THEIR OPINION ABOUT POLITICS, ECONOMICS, SPORTS AND EVEN ART. HOWEVER, THE DIALOGUE IS ALWAYS GEARED TOWARDS PROBLEMS. THE CAFÉ TALK LED BY A MODERATOR, A REPORT AND A COMMUNITY MANAGER WILL USE A STRUCTURE THAT EXTRACTS A TANGIBLE SOLUTION AT THE END OF THE DISCUSSION. CAFÉ TALKS CAN TAKE VARIOUS FORMAT INCLUDING COMPETITIONS BETWEEN THE REGIONS TO GET MORE YOUTH INVOLVED.

Our Programs

MA3AN

MA3AN IS A USAID FUNDED PROJECT THAT TARGETS THE CREATION OF 30 RESILIENT COMMUNITIES IN TUNISIA THROUGH PARTNERSHIPS WITH LOCAL NGOS AND IIDEBATE IS THE LOCAL PARTNER WORKING ON NADHOUR, ZAGHOUAN. AFTER SELECTING AND TRAINING A MOTIVATED GROUP OF YOUTH FROM THE REGION, A COMMUNITY MAPPING WAS ACCOMPLISHED TO IDENTIFY THE CHARACTERISTICS OF NADHOUR. THEN, ALL THE RELEVANT STAKEHOLDERS WERE GATHERED IN A COMMUNITY STAKEHOLDERS ACTION PLANNING TO DETERMINE THE STRATEGIES NEEDED TO DEVELOP THE LOCAL COMMUNITY. ACTIVITIES WILL BE DEVISED BASED ON ONE OF THE STRATEGIES TO ACHIEVE THE PROJECT'S GOALS.

ma3an
FOR RESILIENT COMMUNITIES

TABA3 EL 9ANOUN

TO IMPLEMENT THE CULTURE OF LOCAL GOVERNANCE IN TUNISIA, IIDEBATE ORGANIZED "TABA3 EL 9ANOUN". THIS PROJECT AIMS AT INVOLVING YOUTH IN THE DECISION-MAKING PROCESS WHILE RAISING THEIR AWARENESS ABOUT THE POLITICAL CHANGES EXPERIENCED BY TUNISIA. WITH A FOCUS ON A LAW BEING DISCUSSED AT THE PARLIAMENT, YOUNG PARTICIPANTS CONTRIBUTED WITH THEIR SUGGESTIONS TO AMEND THE LAW IN QUESTION. THE PROJECT RELIED ON POLICY DEBATES INVOLVING EXPERTS AND DEPUTIES FROM THE PARLIAMENT. THE EXECUTION WAS IN PARALLEL WITH THE DISCUSSION IN THE PARLIAMENT GIVING THE YOUTH A PRACTICAL EXPERIENCE.

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Our Programs

INNOVATION AND RESEARCH CENTERS

IIDEBATE'S FIRST MAJOR EVENT AIMED AT TACKLING THE CONFUSION OF DECISION MAKING FOR TUNISIAN HIGH SCHOOL STUDENTS. IN PARTNERSHIP WITH THE BRITICH COUNCIL, KHALINI NEKHTAR WAS ORGANIZED TO ENGAGE 1,000 PARTICIPANTS INCLUDING STUDENTS, PROFESSIONALS AND PARENTS FROM TEN REGIONS AROUND THE COUNTRY IN AN EDUCATION FAIR.

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IIDEBATE
Innovation & Research Centers

Our Partners

Microsoft

UNESCO

Tunivisions

BRITISH COUNCIL

U.S. Embassy Tunis

U.S.-Middle East Partnership Initiative
MEPI

JCI

AIESEC

idea ®

African Youth Panel

Université de Carthage
جامعة قرطاج

THEODOR HEUSS KOLLEG

MitOst

The Team

FOUNDERS

ELYES GUERMAZI

WADII BOUGHDIR

SALMA HADDAD

The Team

STAFF

IMEN BOUHAJJA
PROJECT COORDINATOR

ELYES GUERMAZI
EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR

MARWA MIMOUNI
PROJECT COORDINATOR

MAJD BEN CHOBBA
COMMUNICATION OFFICER

IYED HAMADI
REPORTING &
FUNDRAISING OFFICER

CHOUMOUKH FRADI
LEARNING &
DEVELOPMENT OFFICER

AMIR FAKHFAKH
PROJECT OFFICER

YOUSSEF OMRI
PROJECT OFFICER

Board of Directors

SALMA NEGRA

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ANAS FAOURI

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